MappedSkills Brand DNA 4.0 (APPROVED DESIGN DIRECTION)

Approval: the owner approved revision 3 as the design direction on 1 November 2026, with four final corrections, applied here as revision 4. This approves a direction only. It does **not** authorise a site-wide redesign, implementation, commit, push, deployment or Contentful change; each implementation batch needs its own authorisation. Recorded in `DECISION_LOG.md` as DEC-118 (D-13), on the local homepage branch `feat/brand-dna4-homepage`.
Status: revision 4, 1 November 2026. Decisions marked OPEN in section E remain open within the approved direction.
Visual reference: the approved homepage, THE RESOLVE R3, as it stands on `main` `def66d2` (identical homepage code to live `0551b89`).
Supersedes: nothing. It extends Brand DNA 3.0 (24 October 2026) and the DEC-091 typography conventions; it does not replace approved logo artwork, colours, fonts or frozen page designs.

How to read this document

Every important statement carries one label:

Label	Meaning
VERIFIED	Read from code, Git, a decision record or the live site
OWNER REQUIREMENT	Direction given by the owner for this proposal (1 November 2026); still needs recording as a DEC entry
RECOMMENDATION	Proposed by this document; not a rule until approved
OPEN	Needs an owner decision

Measurements carry one of three evidence classes:

Class	Meaning	Examples in this document
NEW (1 Nov 2026)	Measured or checked in this session	Git SHAs and file differences; live HTTP status of case pages; live H1; contrast ratios calculated from the token values; CSS values read from source
HISTORICAL	Recorded earlier by another session; not re-checked here	Section heights and the "text under 12 px" flags recorded on 31 October 2026 (DEC-110, `docs/experience-review/SECTION_HEIGHTS.md`) on a local build at port 3500
UNTESTED	Assumption or expected effect, not yet observed in a browser	Every effect of the recommendations on layout, height, wrapping, readability and motion

Outstanding: the browser audit of the current homepage and of these proposals has not been done. Required audit widths: **1440, 1280, 390 and 360 px**; any other size (for example 1366, 820 or 200% zoom) is additional. No statement in this document should be read as the audit's result.

Token names drop the CSS custom-property prefix (for example `c-tang` is the homepage token for #FF5B04).

Sources read: `DECISION_LOG.md` (DEC-018, DEC-019, DEC-069, DEC-071, DEC-078 to DEC-091, DEC-102, DEC-110, DEC-111, DEC-117); `CURRENT_STATE.md`; `docs/resolve-sitewide/TYPOGRAPHY_AND_HEADLINE_CONVENTIONS.md`; `components/resolve-home-r3/` (all files); `components/paid-advertising/home/content.ts`; `lib/clients.ts`; `lib/case-study-proof.ts`; `lib/case-

`study-images.ts`; `app/globals.css`; `app/direction-c.css`; `app/layout.tsx`; `docs/case-release/manifest/manifest.json`; Brand DNA 3.0 (owner's external file); Brand Kit README (DEC-069).

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0. Authoritative baseline

Check	Finding	Label
Approved homepage version	THE RESOLVE R3, frozen 27 October 2026 (DEC-085), integrated in `4a3cb8d` (PR #60). Later approved changes: client showcase (DEC-090, in `dc6c9f3`, PR #66) and the logos approved on 31 October (DEC-104 owner decisions, in `b7acea5`).	VERIFIED, NEW
Authoritative SHA	`main` = `def66d2`. Live code = `0551b89` (DEC-117 completion). `0551b89` to `def66d2` changes only four documentation files, so homepage code on `main` equals live. The live H1 matches the source.	VERIFIED, NEW
Baseline decision	Resolved (D-01): the baseline is the verified `main` `def66d2` homepage, identical to live `0551b89`. No further checkout investigation is needed.	OWNER REQUIREMENT
Uncommitted homepage changes	The primary checkout has none in homepage files (its modified files are case-study and Contentful code). `MappedSkills-home-r2` holds uncommitted R2.1 edits to `PaidAdvertisingHome.tsx`, which `app/page.tsx` no longer renders and which DEC-085 says R3 supersedes. Excluded; not approved.	VERIFIED, NEW
Effect on this proposal	None. Homepage code is identical on `main` and live, so every token below is read from `main`.	VERIFIED

A. Brand DNA 4.0 specification

A1. Brand personality and visual philosophy

- **Personality (carried from Brand DNA 3.0):** clear, commercial, candid, disciplined, human, confident. No hype, guarantees or superlatives.
- **Visual idea (THE RESOLVE, DEC-018), VERIFIED:** many anonymous signals resolve into a few named outcomes. Light-first ground, one accent, a dark stage for decisive moments, and a burnt closing band.
- **4.0 principle, RECOMMENDATION:** every section answers one buyer question and shows one idea, and every page gives a clear path to the next step. Drama comes from contrast of ground, scale of type, generous space and at most one purposeful motion, never from decoration.

A2. Colour system

OWNER REQUIREMENT: preserve the existing logo colours and the existing website colours. No colour is added, removed or changed.

Logo artwork (VERIFIED, Brand Kit README, DEC-069): mark #FF5F24, "Skills" #FD5C03, ink #232323, text on dark #FAFAFA. Use the supplied files only; never recolour, stretch or re-typeset.

Website colours (VERIFIED, `resolve-home-r3.css` and `app/globals.css`):

Role	Token / value	Use	Contrast (NEW, calculated from values)
Ground	`c-ground` #F7F3EC	Default light section	Ink on Ground 16.8:1
Paper	`c-paper` #FFFDF9	Raised light section and cards, with a Line border	
Ink	`c-ink` #141219	Text and structure on light	
Ink Deep	`c-deep` #0F0D14	Dark stage sections, footer	
Tangerine	`c-tang` #FF5B04	Emphasis and marks on dark only	6.2:1 on Ink Deep; white on Tangerine 3.11:1, so never small text
Tangerine Dark	`c-tang-dark` #D94400	Display emphasis on light (H1, H2, large H3)	3.97:1 on Ground: large text only
Tangerine Deep	`c-tang-deep` #A83400	Small text, eyebrows, links, primary button, closing band	6.02:1 on Ground; white on it 6.65:1
Line / Rule	#DED6C8 on light, #2C2833 on dark	Rules and borders	
Dim	#5C5665	Secondary text on light	6.38:1 on Ground
Gap	#8E8798	Dashed "your business" graphics only	3.13:1: graphics only, never text
On dark	#E9E4DC body, #CFC8D6 soft, #B7B0BF captions	Text on Ink Deep	about 9.17:1 (#B7B0BF) to 15.25:1 (#E9E4DC); #CFC8D6 11.84:1

The logo and website values differ (for example #FF5F24 against #FF5B04, #232323 against #141219). Both stay: the logo is artwork, the website colours are interface tokens. Neither is adjusted to match the other.

A3. Global typography and responsive hierarchy

Bricolage Grotesque 800 for headings and numerals; Manrope for body, labels, buttons and forms (VERIFIED, self-hosted through `next/font`). Sizes are fluid `clamp()`; breakpoints change layout, not type.

Semantics and typography are separate (RECOMMENDATION). The heading level (H1 to H6) follows the document structure: one H1, then levels in order without skipping. The visual style is chosen by class for the role. A heading's level never decides its size, and a size never decides its level. Any level, including H6, is used wherever the structure requires it. The "H1" to "H5" rows below are visual roles, not element rules.

Visual role	Size	Weight / line height / tracking	Measure	Status
H1	clamp(2.5rem, 4.8vw, 4.3rem)	800 / .99 / -.025em	15ch	VERIFIED
H2 section	clamp(2rem, 4vw, 3.5rem)	800 / 1.05 / -.025em	18ch	VERIFIED
H2 compact (dense sections, pricing)	clamp(1.9rem, 3vw, 2.7rem) to clamp(2rem, 3.6vw, 3.1rem)	same	13 to 30ch	VERIFIED
H2 closing band	clamp(2rem, 4.4vw, 4rem)	800 / 1	16ch	VERIFIED
H3 feature	clamp(1.6rem, 2.7vw, 2.5rem)	800 / 1.05		VERIFIED
H3 card	clamp(1.3rem, 2vw, 1.9rem)	800 / 1.05		VERIFIED

Visual role	Size	Weight / line height / tracking	Measure	Status
H3 small (steps, journey)	clamp(1.05rem, 1.4vw, 1.25rem)	800 / 1.2 / -.015em		VERIFIED
H4	as H3 small	800 / 1.2		Provisional (DEC-091); D-12
H5	1rem Manrope	800		Provisional (DEC-091); D-12
H6 (element)	permitted where the structure needs a sixth level; styled with the H5 or label role			RECOMMENDATION
Hero lead	clamp(1.1rem, 1.6vw, 1.4rem)	600 / 1.45	38ch	VERIFIED
Body	1rem (blocks .95 to 1.05rem)	400 / 1.6	46 to 54ch, never over 72ch	VERIFIED
Label (eyebrow, tag, stage name, legend, chip)	**minimum .75rem (12 px)**	700 to 800 / 1.4 / .1 to .16em uppercase		OWNER REQUIREMENT
Explanatory caption (disclosure, figure note, "illustrative" note, logo note)	**minimum .875rem (14 px)**	500 to 600 / 1.45	60ch	OWNER REQUIREMENT
Button	1rem, minimum height 52px, pill	800 / 1.2		VERIFIED

Current values below the new minimums (VERIFIED, NEW, read from CSS):

Selector	Role	Current	Proposed
`.rv3-eyebrow`	Label	.74rem (11.8 px)	.75rem
`.rv3-ccm span`	Label	.68rem (10.9 px)	.75rem
`.rv3-j-tag`	Label	.7rem (11.2 px)	.75rem
`.rv3-j-n`	Label (step number)	.8rem (12.8 px)	unchanged
`.rv3-s-n`	Label	.74rem (11.8 px)	.75rem
`.rv3-legend`	Label	.8rem (12.8 px)	removed with the diagram (D-08)
`.rv3-hero-fig small`	Caption	.8rem (12.8 px)	.875rem
`.rv3-w-note`	Caption	.78rem (12.5 px)	.875rem
`.rv3-s-cap`	Caption	.8rem (12.8 px)	.875rem
`.cl-note` (client wall)	Caption	not measured in this session	.875rem if smaller

The demo mock-ups (search result and social feed) imitate platform interfaces at platform sizes. RECOMMENDATION: treat them as images; their inner text is exempt, but their captions follow the 14 px rule.

Editorial pages already meet these minimums: DEC-112 set a type floor of 12 px labels and 14 px notes for blog, press and research (superseding the 11 px kicker note in DEC-109), and the implemented `components/editorial/editorial.css` on `main` sets its kickers, chips and chapter labels at .75rem (12 px) (VERIFIED, NEW). The minimums therefore change the homepage and other non-editorial pages only.

UNTESTED: the effect of the larger labels and captions on wrapping and section height. Expected to be small; to be checked in the outstanding browser audit.

A4. Dual-tone H1 and H2 rules

Keeps the DEC-091 rule set (VERIFIED), with RECOMMENDED additions in items 4 to 7:

1. The emphasised phrase (`<em>`, normal style) carries the **customer outcome or the meaningful contrast**, chosen by meaning, not position.
2. Guidance, not a limit: usually about five words or fewer, and always less than the whole heading. Meaning decides; word count only flags a heading for a second look.
3. Light ground: Ink with #D94400. Dark ground: white with #FF5B04. Closing band: white only.
4. One emphasis per heading. Card titles, FAQ questions, legal headings and small section headings are normally single-colour.
5. **Approved editorial treatments are preserved:** the dual-tone headlines on blog, press and research pages (DEC-077, DEC-109; emphasis is the part of the recorded headline after its first colon or bar, `lib/headline-emphasis.ts`) stay as approved.
6. Where no phrase is an outcome or a contrast, use a single-colour heading. Labels such as "Businesses we've worked with" stay single-colour.
7. Punctuation: full sentences end with a full stop; phrase headlines take none. The homepage mixes both today (VERIFIED).

A5. Section composition and whitespace

OWNER REQUIREMENT: preserve natural section heights and generous spacing.

VERIFIED tokens, kept unchanged:

- Container: 1360px maximum, side padding clamp(16px, 4vw, 56px); 12-column grid, gutter clamp(16px, 2vw, 32px).
- Section padding `sec` clamp(52px, 6vw, 96px); dense sections may use clamp(48px, 4.4vw, 64px), as Services does today.
- Spacing scale `sp-1` to `sp-4`: 10 to 16, 16 to 28, 24 to 44, 32 to 64 px. No one-off margins.
- Heading block to content: `sp-4`. Radius: 4px cards and media, 999px buttons, 8px logo chips.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

- Spacing is never reduced to save height. Where a section is long, remove repeated content (as in D-08), not space.
- Ground rhythm: alternate Ink Deep, Ground and Paper; never two Ink Deep sections together. Commercial pages end with the Tangerine Deep band; other pages use their approved endings (A11). The dark footer follows on every page.
- Composition: asymmetric 7/5 or 6/6 splits, one lead item with offset supporting items; three equal cards only where content is truly parallel.

A6. Fold management without forced viewport heights

Follows DEC-111 (VERIFIED owner correction):

- No `100vh` or viewport-tied minimum heights. Every section takes its natural height.
- Desktop: a section stays within one screen when its content fits comfortably; otherwise it is allowed more height.
- Mobile: content flows; no text below the type scale, no clipping, no splitting of a coherent section to fit a screen.

- Hero (RECOMMENDATION, a preference, not a requirement): where it fits comfortably, the H1, lead and primary CTA appear in the first screen at 1440 x 900 and 1280 x 720 (the DEC-087 How We Work standard). Readability and spacing take precedence: the hero is never compressed, shrunk or crowded to achieve it. UNTESTED for the homepage in this session.
- Quality is judged with the seven DEC-111 checks: readability, spacing, hierarchy, content density, narrative continuity, useful motion, clear next action.

A7. Distinct section drama and purposeful animation

Homepage motion inventory (VERIFIED from source, NEW; timing not observed in a browser):

Pattern	Mechanism	Current duration	Role
Hero story (dots, attention, ad, outcomes)	CSS keyframes on SVG; the final frame is the base style	about 4.4s in total, once	Explains the idea
Section entrance	IntersectionObserver, only below the first screen; visible without script	.42s, 14px rise, once	Orientation
Buyer path draw	Observer arms, then nodes and lines draw in order	.75s per step, once	Cause and effect (removed under D-08)
Hover and focus	colour, 2px arrow shift, 2px button lift, FAQ plus rotates	.18s	Feedback
Reduced motion	all animation and transition removed	none	Accessibility

Motion limits are ceilings, not required durations (OWNER REQUIREMENT). A shorter animation, or none, always complies. RECOMMENDED ceilings:

Motion type	Ceiling
Hover and focus feedback	no more than 200ms
Section entrance	no more than 500ms, rise no more than 16px
Any single transition	no more than 500ms
Signature sequence (at most one per page, optional)	no more than 5s in total, plays once, final frame identical to the static design
Stagger between related items	no more than 100ms per item, no more than four items

Never: counters, sticky stages, scroll hijack, parallax, autoplay, looping motion, animated text, or content that is hidden until an animation finishes.

Drama per section comes first from a change of ground, scale of type and one strong visual; motion is the last tool.

A8. Customer-first storytelling principles

- Plan each section around the buyer's question it answers, then lead with the outcome and show how. The question is a planning tool, not a compulsory literal heading; a page may show it, as How We Work does with "You ask" (DEC-087), where that helps the reader.
- Speak to "you" and "your customers"; MappedSkills is the guide, not the hero.
- Separate what MappedSkills does from what the business owns (the existing Capture, Convert and Measure split).
- Proof follows a claim directly. Every figure carries its source, period and caveat. Illustrations are described accurately; a visible "illustrative" note is used where the approved pattern has one, within the disclosure

exceptions in A13 (no visible disclosure on /work cards or in the case showcase).

A9. Benefit-led, concise content-writing rules

- Lead with the benefit within the first six words. One idea per sentence; aim for 20 words or fewer.
- Headlines 4 to 10 words; section introductions two sentences at most; card text one or two sentences.
- Plain words over platform jargon; translate metrics into business meaning.
- Banned: guarantees, superlatives, and "ROI-driven", "data-driven" or "results-focused" without evidence. No invented numbers.
- No double dashes or long dashes; use full stops, commas or colons.
- Title Case for buttons and links (existing convention); sentence case for headings.

A10. Page-specific storytelling architecture

Commercial-page recipe (RECOMMENDATION). Service, audience (industry), homepage and similar selling pages follow six stages. Editorial, legal and utility pages (blog, press, research, legal, FAQ, contact, thank-you, 404) are not bound by it; they follow their own approved structures.

1. **Recognition:** is this for me?
2. **Tension:** what goes wrong today?
3. **Approach:** how does it work?
4. **Proof:** real work, with honest limits.
5. **Fit and cost:** who it suits and what is included.
6. **Action:** one clear next step.

Commercial pages may merge or skip stages but never put Proof before Recognition. Section D gives each page's direction.

A11. CTA hierarchy and conversion journeys

VERIFIED labels (DEC-085): "Discuss Your Advertising", "Discuss Your Google Ads", "Discuss Your Meta Ads", "Discuss Property Advertising". Call requests go to `/contact?intent=call` (DEC-071).

RECOMMENDED hierarchy:

- **A clear journey, not a CTA in every section.** Each page makes the next step easy to find; individual sections carry a CTA only where it helps.
- **Primary:** pill button, Tangerine Deep on light, Paper on the closing band. Where used, at most one per section and two per screen.
- **Secondary:** underlined text link with ↗ ("Explore Our Work", "See How We Work").
- **Tertiary:** inline contextual links.
- **Journeys:** Home to a service or audience page, to a case study, to `/contact` (enquiry or call). Commercial pages end with the closing band CTA; other pages use their approved ending.

A12. Mobile-first layouts and accessibility

- Breakpoints (VERIFIED, layout only): 1080, 760 and 420 px. Below 760 px, sequences become vertical numbered timelines (journey and steps already do).
- Touch targets: 44px for links, 52px for buttons (VERIFIED in CSS).

- Visible focus: 3px #A83400 on light, white on dark (VERIFIED in CSS).
- WCAG 2.2 AA: contrast as in A2; one H1; no skipped heading levels; decorative SVGs hidden; no information that depends on animation.
- Required audit widths: 1440, 1280, 390 and 360 px. Additional sizes (1366, 820, 200% zoom) are optional extras. The consent banner must not hide the primary CTA (DEC-085 correction notes). This audit is outstanding.

A13. Reusable components and permitted variations

Component	Permitted variations
Section shell (ground, wrap, head)	Ink Deep, Ground or Paper; standard or compact padding
Section head (eyebrow, H2, intro, optional side link)	dual-tone or single-colour H2
Button and text link	Tangerine Deep or Paper; light or dark
Lead card with offset cards	image above or beside; one lead plus two
Numbered sequence (journey, steps)	horizontal on desktop, vertical on mobile; ownership marks (solid for MappedSkills, dashed for your business)
Platform demo (search result, social feed)	always captioned as illustrative
Homepage work card (artwork, logo chip, eyebrow, title, link)	links to the case detail page; keeps its existing approved homepage treatment
/work R2 library card (DEC-108, accepted)	as approved: two columns on desktop, one on mobile; Search, Service and Industry filters with result count; card image shown whole; client name as the single link; service label and one line; the study's own lead figure with definition and period, or its approved summary; no visible artwork disclosure under the image (removed by owner decision, 31 October 2026)
Reusable case showcase (`components/case-showcase/`, DEC-115 and DEC-116, accepted)	as approved: one section per page with two or three relevant cases; grid on desktop, swipeable row at 1080 px and below with previous and next buttons and a "Case N of M" status; one once-only artwork reveal; hides at zero cases; View-all link rules as recorded; no visible artwork disclosure
Client logo wall	always with the "a logo shows who, not a result" note; homepage position unchanged
FAQ (`details`)	dark or light
Closing band	heading, one sentence, one CTA

Artwork disclosure: there is no universal visible-disclosure requirement. The approved removals on /work and in the showcase stand; alt text and detail-page captions carry the description. Existing visible notes on pages that already have them (such as the homepage) are not changed by this document.

Not permitted without approval: new colours, new fonts, glow or gradient decoration, stock photography presented as client work, dashboards with invented numbers.

A14. Design QA and acceptance checklist

1. One H1; heading levels follow structure (H6 allowed where needed); styles chosen by role; A4 dual-tone rules met.
2. Only A2 colours; logo files unaltered; contrast pairs as listed.
3. Paragraphs 16 px; labels 12 px minimum; explanatory captions 14 px minimum.
4. Lines 72 characters at most.

5. Preferred, not required: hero H1, lead and CTA in the first screen at 1440 and 1280 px, without compromising readability or spacing.
6. Checked at 1440, 1280, 390 and 360 px: no horizontal overflow, no clipped or overlapping text.
7. Every claim traceable; illustrations described accurately (alt text, captions where the approved pattern uses them); every logo authorised in `lib/clients.ts`.
8. Motion within the A7 ceilings; nothing moves under reduced motion; all content present without script.
9. Every focusable element shows a ring; targets meet A12.
10. A clear journey to the next step on every page; CTA labels from A11.
11. Section spacing uses the A5 tokens; no section compressed to save height.
12. No console errors; media dimensions reserved so nothing shifts.
13. Copy passes A9.

B. Existing versus proposed rules

Area	Existing (VERIFIED)	Proposed 4.0
Logo colours	#FF5F24, #FD5C03, #232323 in artwork	Preserved unchanged (owner requirement)
Website colours	Ten tokens scoped to `.rv3`; same values in `resolve-*` globals	Preserved unchanged; roles and contrast limits documented
Labels	10.9 to 11.8 px in several places	12 px minimum
Explanatory captions	12.5 to 12.8 px	14 px minimum
Heading levels	H4 and H5 scale provisional (DEC-091); H6 not used for outline	Semantics separate from typography; H4 and H5 roles confirmed (D-12); H6 allowed where structure needs it
Headline emphasis	Outcome or contrast, about five words	Chosen by meaning; word count is guidance; approved editorial dual-tone kept; punctuation rule
Fold	No strict fold rule (DEC-111)	Same; first-screen hero fit is a preference behind readability and spacing
Storytelling	Brand DNA 3.0 arc for all pages	Six stages for commercial pages only; buyer questions as a planning tool
CTAs	DEC-085 labels	Same labels; a clear journey per page, not a CTA per section
Artwork disclosure	Removed on /work and showcases (31 October)	Removal kept; no universal requirement
Case components	/work R2 and showcase accepted (DEC-108, DEC-116)	Recorded as explicit component variants
Audit widths	Earlier checks used 1440, 820, 390, 360	Required: 1440, 1280, 390, 360; others additional
Spacing	Fluid tokens `sec`, `sp-1` to `sp-4`	Same tokens; never reduced to save height
Motion	Brand DNA 3.0 proposed 180 to 320ms; homepage uses .42s entrances; DEC-111 checks used 500ms	Ceilings, not durations: 500ms per transition, 5s signature sequence
Homepage cases	Wanderlooms and Om Sai, both linking to `/work`	AnybodyCanBake Google Ads and Wanderlooms Meta Ads, each linking to its detail page
Process section	Five steps plus a buyer-path diagram	Five steps; diagram removed, unique facts kept

C. Homepage section refinement matrix

Heights are **HISTORICAL** (recorded 31 October 2026 at 1440 and 390 px, DEC-110; not re-checked; the homepage's client data changed afterwards in `b7acea5`). All effects of the proposed changes are **UNTESTED**.

#	Section (ground)	Height 1440 / 390	Keep unchanged	Refine	Simplify or consolidate	Decision
1	Hero (Ink Deep)	775 / 1059	H1, lead, support line, CTA pair, hero story animation	Disclosure caption to 14 px	None	D-03
2	Buyer journey (Ground)	788 / 1378	Five stages, Capture, Convert and Measure, ownership marks	Labels to 12 px; emphasis "to an enquiry or a sale." names the outcome, so it stays (word count is guidance)	Receives the one responsibility sentence from section 7 (see D-08)	D-03, D-08
3	Who we help (Paper)	978 / 1504	Lead plus two layout, imagery, Enquiry-Led pointer	None	None	
4	Services (Ink Deep)	799 / 1830	Two services, illustrative demos with captions	Captions to 14 px; check demo scale at 390 px	None	D-03
5	Featured work (Ground)	1068 / 1308	Card layout, logo chips, disclosure notes	Cards become AnybodyCanBake Google Ads and Wanderlooms Meta Ads with direct detail links; captions to 14 px; emphasis "the work" is not an outcome	Removes the stale code that sends both cards to `/work`	D-05, D-06, D-10
6	Clients (Paper)	567 / 1002	Logo wall, note and current position	Heading single-colour by meaning	None	D-07, D-10
7	Process (Ground)	1297 / 1930	Five steps; reporting sentence (DEC-085 D4); "See How We Work" link	None	Buyer-path diagram removed; unique facts kept (see below)	D-08
8	Pricing and FAQ (Ink Deep)	547 / 824	Fee separation, four FAQs	FAQ title is an H2 styled as an eyebrow: acceptable, document it	None	
9	Closing band (Tangerine Deep)	384 / 344	As is	None	None	
n/a	Code comments	n/a	n/a	Header comment still calls R3 "a DESIGN EXPERIMENT", which contradicts DEC-085; "6. Paper" sits on a Ground section	No visual change	

C1. Recommended homepage cases (D-05, D-06)

Card	Route	Live status (NEW)	Evidence basis (VERIFIED)	Assets (VERIFIED)
AnybodyCanBake, Google Ads	`/portfolio/google-ads-for-online-courses`	200; page names AnybodyCanBake	Figures released 30 October 2026 (DEC-102): owner attested the figures and gave permission to publish figures and images (`lib/case-study-proof.ts`)	Approved logo in `lib/clients.ts`; case card artwork in `lib/case-study-images.ts`
Wanderlooms, Meta Ads	`/portfolio/wanderlooms-meta-ads`	200	Published in the DEC-117 release (listing order 20)	Approved logo and conceptual artwork already on the homepage

Why: one Google Ads and one Meta Ads case mirrors the two core services; both have live detail pages; today both homepage cards are Meta Ads and both send visitors to `/work` instead of the case.

Rules for the cards: link each card directly to its detail page with "Read the Case Study" (Title Case, following A11); reuse each case's approved title and card text from Contentful; repeat no figure that the case page does not publish; keep the existing homepage treatment for Wanderlooms and add no new visible disclosure requirement (the /work and showcase removals stand). Spelling is "AnybodyCanBake" (DEC-102).

Om Sai Developer leaves the homepage but stays first on `/work` and keeps its detail page.

C2. Process diagram removal with unique information kept (D-08)

The buyer-path diagram (`PathFlow`) repeats the journey in section 2. A line-by-line comparison (VERIFIED, NEW):

Diagram content	Already in section 2?	Disposition
Five stages: buyer intent, relevant advertising, website or landing page, enquiry or purchase, measurement and improvement	Yes, as the five journey stages	Removed
Ownership legend (MappedSkills, your business, your customer)	Partly: ownership marks and Capture, Convert, Measure labels	Keep one short legend in section 2 if the marks need explaining
"Website or landing page" owned by your business	Yes: "Your business: offer, website and follow up"	Removed
"MappedSkills tests and reviews"	Partly: "MappedSkills reviews"	Section 2 label becomes "MappedSkills tests and reviews"
Footnote: "MappedSkills plans, manages, tests and reviews advertising within the agreed scope. Your business owns the offer, the website and the follow up."	No: "within the agreed scope" is unique	Moves to section 2 as one sentence below the journey
Heading "How the advertising connects to the buyer's path"	Same idea as section 2's H2	Removed

The five process steps, the reporting sentence and the "See How We Work" link stay in section 7. Section spacing stays unchanged. UNTESTED: the expected height reduction in section 7.

D. Page storytelling principles (direction only, no replacement pages)

Page	Story	Signature moment (optional, within A7 ceilings)	Constraints
Google Ads	People already searching; are they finding you; how campaigns meet that intent; what you supply (offer, page, tracking); Google Ads proof; fees; discuss	A search result resolving from query to enquiry	Frozen R4.1 design and H1 kept (DEC-085); proof from published Google Ads cases only
Meta Ads	Attention in the feed; turning it into opportunity; audience, message and creative tests; Click-to-WhatsApp where relevant; Meta Ads proof; creative allowance and fees; discuss	One creative test resolving into a conversation	Frozen R2.2; tracking boundary from DEC-080
Industry pages (D2C, Education, Real Estate, Enquiry-Led)	How your buyers decide; what success means for you (purchase, enrolment, site visit, qualified enquiry); channel fit; sector proof; fit	The sector's own buying path	Frozen designs kept; only shared rules apply
Case study	Client context; problem; what changed; evidence with period and source; limits; next step	One static before and after, no counting animation	DEC-117 content gate and eligibility rules unchanged
How We Work	Six acts, each opening with "You ask" (DEC-087)	Route diagram with the approval gate	Already the model for 4.0 storytelling
Contact	What happens next; enquiry or call; short form; privacy; calm confirmation	None beyond input feedback	Two intents (DEC-071); no pressure copy

E. Decision and approval register

"Owner direction" means the owner set the direction on 1 November 2026. Brand DNA 4.0 as a whole is approved as the design direction (revision 3, corrected in revision 4); OPEN items below stay open within it. Recorded as DEC-118. Nothing here authorises implementation.

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Status
D-01	Authoritative homepage baseline	Verified `main` `def66d2`, identical homepage to live `0551b89`; no further checkout investigation	Resolved by owner direction
D-02	Logo colours (#FF5F24, #FD5C03, #232323) and website colours (#FF5B04, #141219 and the rest of A2)	Preserve both sets unchanged, each in its own scope	Owner direction given
D-03	Minimum sizes: labels 12 px, explanatory captions 14 px (changes frozen pages slightly)	Approve; apply page by page in later implementation batches	Owner direction given
D-04	Motion ceilings: transitions no more than 500ms; optional signature sequence no more than 5s, once, static final frame	Approve as ceilings, not required durations	Owner direction given (ceilings); values OPEN
D-05	Homepage cases: AnybodyCanBake Google Ads and Wanderlooms Meta Ads	Approve	Owner direction given
D-06	Direct detail links for both cards, with approved CMS title and card text, "Read the Case Study" label	Approve	Owner direction given (links); card wording OPEN
D-07	Client logo wall position	Keep its current position after Featured work	Resolved by owner direction

ID	Decision	Recommendation	Status
D-08	Remove the buyer-path diagram; move its unique scope sentence and "tests and reviews" wording into the journey section	Approve	Owner direction given
D-09	Heading punctuation: sentences take a full stop, phrases do not	Approve	OPEN
D-10	Emphasis by meaning: journey emphasis kept; work and clients headings single-colour; approved editorial dual-tone kept	Approve	Owner direction given (meaning-led, editorial kept); homepage fixes OPEN
D-11	Brand DNA 4.0 ceilings replace Brand DNA 3.0's 180 to 320ms entrance guidance	Approve	OPEN
D-12	Separate heading semantics from typography; confirm the H4 and H5 visual roles; allow H6 where structure needs it	Approve	Owner direction given (semantics, H6); H4 and H5 roles OPEN
D-13	Record Brand DNA 4.0 as a DEC entry and treat this file as its reference	Recorded as DEC-118	Direction approved 1 November 2026; DEC-118 written locally, not yet on `main`

F. Evidence register

NEW (measured or checked 1 November 2026):

- Git: `main` `def66d2`; live code `0551b89`; their difference is four documentation files; the checkout comparisons in section 0.
- Live site: the homepage H1; `/portfolio/google-ads-for-online-courses`, `/portfolio/wanderlooms-meta-ads`, `/portfolio/om-sai-developer-meta-ads`, `/work` and `/who-we-help/enquiry-led-businesses` return 200; `/portfolio/anybodycanbake-google-ads` returns 404 (the case lives at the online-courses route).
- Contrast ratios in A2, calculated from the hex values (not measured on rendered pages).
- Every CSS value, motion timing and component structure quoted, read from source on `main`.

HISTORICAL (recorded earlier, not re-checked):

- Section heights at 1440 and 390 px and the "text under 12 px" flags, recorded 31 October 2026 on a local build (DEC-110, `docs/experience-review/SECTION_HEIGHTS.md`).
- Hero fit at the three desktop sizes on `/how-it-works` (DEC-087).

UNTESTED (assumptions):

- Wrapping and height effects of the 12 px and 14 px minimums.
- Height reduction from removing the diagram.
- Layout of the new case cards with AnybodyCanBake artwork and logo.
- Homepage hero fit at 1440 x 900 and 1280 x 720 (a preference, not a requirement).
- Rendered contrast, motion timing in a visible browser, Safari, Firefox, real devices and screen readers.

OUTSTANDING: the browser audit of the current homepage and of every recommendation above, at the required widths 1440, 1280, 390 and 360 px (other sizes additional).